

PROMPT ENGINEERING

30 Multiple-Choice Questions for Freshers

Questions • Four Options • Correct Answers • Simple Justifications

Purpose

This beginner-friendly question bank covers prompt basics, zero-shot, one-shot, few-shot, role-based, context-based, instruction-based, constraint-based, negative and output-format prompting. It also introduces temperature, iteration, hallucination and system prompts.

How to use

First select your answer without looking at the solution. Then read the correct answer and justification to understand the concept.

1. What is Prompt Engineering?

- A. Developing computer hardware
- B. Writing clear instructions for an AI model
- C. Creating databases
- D. Testing networks

Correct Answer: B. Writing clear instructions for an AI model

Justification: Prompt engineering is the practice of designing clear and effective instructions so that an AI model can understand the task and produce the expected result.

2. What is a prompt?

- A. An instruction or question given to an AI
- B. An AI database
- C. A programming error
- D. A computer virus

Correct Answer: A. An instruction or question given to an AI

Justification: A prompt is the input given to an AI. It may be a question, instruction, request, context, or a combination of these.

3. Which prompt is more effective?

- A. Write something
- B. Explain
- C. Explain Python loops with a simple example for beginners
- D. Give information

Correct Answer: C. Explain Python loops with a simple example for beginners

Justification: Option C clearly defines the topic, expected explanation, audience, and requirement for an example, so the AI has enough direction.

4. What is Zero-shot Prompting?

- A. Providing many examples
- B. Asking AI to complete a task without providing examples
- C. Giving one example
- D. Asking AI to generate an image

Correct Answer: B. Asking AI to complete a task without providing examples

Justification: In zero-shot prompting, the AI receives an instruction but no sample answer or example to copy.

5. What is One-shot Prompting?

- A. Providing exactly one example before asking the AI to perform a task
- B. Providing no examples
- C. Providing many examples
- D. Asking only one question

Correct Answer: A. Providing exactly one example before asking the AI to perform a task

Justification: One-shot prompting gives the model one example that demonstrates the pattern or expected response.

6. What is Few-shot Prompting?

- A. Providing no instructions
- B. Giving two or more examples before asking the AI to perform a similar task
- C. Asking very short questions
- D. Using only programming prompts

Correct Answer: B. Giving two or more examples before asking the AI to perform a similar task

Justification: Few-shot prompting supplies multiple examples so the AI can identify the pattern and apply it to a new input.

7. Which is an example of Role-based Prompting?

- A. Explain Java
- B. Act as a Java trainer and explain inheritance to beginners
- C. Java is a programming language
- D. Write Java

Correct Answer: B. Act as a Java trainer and explain inheritance to beginners

Justification: The phrase 'Act as a Java trainer' assigns a role. This guides the tone, expertise, and teaching style of the response.

8. Which is an example of Output-format Prompting?

- A. Explain FastAPI
- B. Explain FastAPI in a table with columns: Feature, Meaning and Example
- C. What is FastAPI?
- D. FastAPI is useful

Correct Answer: B. Explain FastAPI in a table with columns: Feature, Meaning and Example

Justification: Option B clearly specifies that the response must be presented as a table and even defines the required columns.

9. What is Constraint-based Prompting?

- A. Giving specific limitations or rules to the AI
- B. Asking without instructions
- C. Providing only examples
- D. Deleting the AI response

Correct Answer: A. Giving specific limitations or rules to the AI

Justification: Constraints set boundaries such as length, tone, language, topics to include, or topics to avoid.

10. Which prompt contains a constraint?

- A. Explain Python
- B. Explain Python in exactly five simple sentences
- C. What is Python?
- D. Write about programming

Correct Answer: B. Explain Python in exactly five simple sentences

Justification: The words 'exactly five simple sentences' place clear limits on the length and complexity of the response.

11. What is Negative Prompting?

- A. Asking AI not to perform certain actions or include certain content
- B. Giving negative feedback to the user
- C. Writing an incorrect prompt
- D. Stopping the AI model

Correct Answer: A. Asking AI not to perform certain actions or include certain content

Justification: Negative prompting tells the model what it must avoid, such as unwanted words, styles, content, or actions.

12. Which is an example of Negative Prompting?

- A. Write an email
- B. Write a professional email and do not use informal words or emojis
- C. Explain an email
- D. Send an email

Correct Answer: B. Write a professional email and do not use informal words or emojis

Justification: The instruction explicitly tells the AI not to use informal words or emojis, making it a negative constraint.

13. What is Context-based Prompting?

- A. Providing background information relevant to the task
- B. Asking a question without details
- C. Giving only an output format
- D. Providing no instructions

Correct Answer: A. Providing background information relevant to the task

Justification: Context provides useful background that helps the AI understand the situation and create a more relevant response.

14. Which prompt provides proper context?

- A. Write a message
- B. I completed a GenAI training program for freshers. Write a short LinkedIn post celebrating the achievement
- C. Write something good
- D. Give content

Correct Answer: B. I completed a GenAI training program for freshers. Write a short LinkedIn post celebrating the achievement

Justification: Option B explains what happened, identifies the audience, states the platform, and defines the purpose of the post.

15. What is Instruction-based Prompting?

- A. Giving clear steps or directions to the AI
- B. Giving no task
- C. Asking AI to guess the requirement
- D. Providing only a title

Correct Answer: A. Giving clear steps or directions to the AI

Justification: Instruction-based prompting directly tells the AI what action to perform, such as explain, summarize, compare, or generate.

16. Why are clear prompts important?

- A. They always reduce internet speed
- B. They help AI understand the task and generate a relevant response
- C. They replace programming languages
- D. They increase computer memory

Correct Answer: B. They help AI understand the task and generate a relevant response

Justification: Clear prompts reduce ambiguity and make it easier for the AI to return an accurate, useful, and properly formatted response.

17. Which is a poorly written prompt?

- A. Summarize this paragraph in three bullet points
- B. Act as an interviewer and ask five Python questions
- C. Write something about it
- D. Explain SQL joins using a simple table

Correct Answer: C. Write something about it

Justification: Option C is vague because it does not identify the topic, audience, purpose, length, or expected output.

18. What does 'temperature' generally control in an AI model?

- A. Internet speed
- B. Response creativity and randomness
- C. Database size
- D. Number of users

Correct Answer: B. Response creativity and randomness

Justification: Temperature is a model setting that influences how predictable or varied the generated response may be.

19. A lower temperature generally produces:

- A. More focused and predictable responses
- B. More random responses
- C. No response
- D. Only images

Correct Answer: A. More focused and predictable responses

Justification: A lower temperature normally favors more likely word choices, which makes responses more consistent and focused.

20. A higher temperature generally produces:

- A. More creative and varied responses
- B. More predictable responses only
- C. Shorter prompts
- D. Faster internet

Correct Answer: A. More creative and varied responses

Justification: A higher temperature allows greater variation in word selection, which can increase creativity as well as unpredictability.

21. What is Prompt Iteration?

- A. Improving a prompt based on the previous response
- B. Using a prompt only once
- C. Deleting all prompts
- D. Converting prompts into databases

Correct Answer: A. Improving a prompt based on the previous response

Justification: Prompt iteration means reviewing the AI's output and refining the prompt until the result better matches the requirement.

22. If the AI response is too technical, what should you do?

- A. Stop using AI
- B. Ask it to explain the topic in simple language for beginners
- C. Delete the application
- D. Increase the computer memory

Correct Answer: B. Ask it to explain the topic in simple language for beginners

Justification: You can refine the prompt by specifying the audience and desired language level, such as 'for beginners' or 'in simple words.'

23. Which prompt is best for generating beginner-friendly content?

- A. Explain RAG
- B. Explain RAG to a fresher using a library-book example in five simple steps
- C. RAG
- D. Give technical data

Correct Answer: B. Explain RAG to a fresher using a library-book example in five simple steps

Justification: Option B specifies the topic, audience, analogy, number of steps, and simplicity level, making the request clear and beginner-friendly.

24. What is the main purpose of specifying the audience in a prompt?

- A. To adjust the language and complexity of the response
- B. To increase the screen size
- C. To install software
- D. To create a password

Correct Answer: A. To adjust the language and complexity of the response

Justification: Audience information helps the AI select suitable vocabulary, depth, tone, examples, and technical complexity.

25. Which prompt requests a structured response?

- A. Explain machine learning
- B. Compare AI and machine learning in a table
- C. Tell me something
- D. AI information

Correct Answer: B. Compare AI and machine learning in a table

Justification: A table is a defined structure that organizes information into rows and columns for easier comparison.

26. What is hallucination in Generative AI?

- A. When AI generates incorrect or unsupported information
- B. When AI runs faster
- C. When AI generates only images
- D. When the computer shuts down

Correct Answer: A. When AI generates incorrect or unsupported information

Justification: An AI hallucination occurs when the model presents false, invented, or unsupported information as if it were correct.

27. Which instruction can help reduce hallucination?

- A. Guess the answer
- B. Answer only using the provided context; if the answer is unavailable, say 'I don't know'
- C. Be highly creative
- D. Generate random information

Correct Answer: B. Answer only using the provided context; if the answer is unavailable, say 'I don't know'

Justification: This instruction limits the AI to supplied evidence and provides a safe fallback when the requested information is missing.

28. What is a system prompt generally used for?

- A. Defining the AI's overall behaviour and rules
- B. Installing the operating system
- C. Restarting the computer
- D. Creating a database table

Correct Answer: A. Defining the AI's overall behaviour and rules

Justification: A system prompt sets high-level behaviour, role, priorities, and rules that guide the AI throughout an interaction.

29. Which prompt combines role, task and format?

- A. Python
- B. Act as a Python trainer, explain lists to freshers and present the answer in a table
- C. Tell me about lists
- D. Give code

Correct Answer: B. Act as a Python trainer, explain lists to freshers and present the answer in a table

Justification: It includes a role (Python trainer), a task (explain lists), an audience (freshers), and an output format (table).

30. Which formula represents a well-structured prompt?

- A. Role + Context + Task + Constraints + Output Format
- B. Question + Password
- C. Code + Database
- D. Name + Number

Correct Answer: A. Role + Context + Task + Constraints + Output Format

Justification: Combining role, context, task, constraints, and format gives the AI a complete and organized description of the expected result.